

Marcelo S. O. Goncalves

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Affiliation

University of Michigan Assistant Professor at the School for Environment and Sustainability (SEAS)	Ann Arbor, MI, USA August 2026 - present
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Education

Duke University PhD in Public Policy MA Economics	Durham, NC, USA July 2026
University of California, San Diego Master of International Affairs / Public Policy ◦ Certificates: Policy Design and Evaluation; Quantitative Analysis	San Diego, CA, USA June 2018
University of Brasilia MA Political Science BA Political Science	Brasilia, Brazil April 2007 March 2005
National School of Public Administration Specialization in Public Policy and Management	Brasilia, Brazil June 2006

Publications

Peer-reviewed publications

- Article: [Building resilience in the Global South: Evidence from a decentralized water policy in Brazil](#) [↗](#) - *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management (JEEM)*
- Article: [Book Bans in Political Context: Evidence from U.S. Public Schools](#) [↗](#) (2024) *PNAS Nexus*. (with Isabelle Langrock, Jack LaViolette, & Katie Spoon)
- Book Chapter: [Data-Driven Implementation: The Role of Information and Technology in Public Responses to Social Emergencies](#) [↗](#). in: *Pandemic, Lockdown, and Digital Transformation: Challenges and Opportunities for Public Administration, NGOs, and Businesses* (2021): 25-45. (With Bruno B. Cardoso)

Working Papers/ Work in Progress

- The Political Logic of Persistent Deforestation: Electoral Incentives and Public Goods in the Brazilian Amazon (with Pablo Beramendi) - *Submitted/ Editorial Decision Pending*.
- [Grassroots Guardians: How collective institutions Amplify Efforts Against Deforestation in Brazil](#) [↗](#). (With Mateo Villamizar-Chaparro & Subhrendu Pattanayak)
- Institutions, Incentives, and Identity in Land Use Decisions: A Micro-Level Analysis of Deforestation Drivers in the Global South (with Paula J. Sarmiento)
- Access to Water and Climate Change: Adaptation, Fertility Decisions and Birth Outcomes in the Brazilian Semiarid Region (with Marcos Rangel)
- Environmental Governance and Land-Based Conflict: How Environmental Policy Reduces Conflict in the Amazon

Policy reports

- [Climate Related Game Changers: Enhancing Adaptation Program Impact to Address Climate Game Changers](#) [↗](#). Research Technical Assistance Center: Washington, DC. Briefing available [here](#) [↗](#). (with Sarah Bermeo, Sarah W. Dickerson, & Paula J. Sarmiento)

Book chapters

- “O Programa Cisternas como Estratégia de Adaptação Climática (The Cistern Program as a Climate Adaptation Strategy)”. in: *Água para colher futuro: 20 anos do Programa Cisternas* (2024).

- “Food security and nutrition and the human right to adequate food in Brazil: monitoring indicators and the constitution of 1988 to today” [📄](#) (2010). Conselho Nacional de Segurança Alimentar e Nutricional, Brasília, DF. 284 p.

Teaching

Instructor of Records

Duke University

Durham, NC, USA

2025

- Political Economy of the Climate and Environment. Graduate seminar for PhD and advanced Master’s students.

Teaching Assistant

Duke University

Durham, NC, USA

2022-2024

- Graduate-level courses: Introduction to Statistics; Causal Inference; Master’s Project; and Evaluation of Public Expenditures.

Teaching Assistant

University of California, San Diego

San Diego, CA, USA

2016-2018

- Undergraduate courses: Introduction to Statistics, Power and Justice, Introduction to International Relations.
- Graduate courses: Globalization.

Lecturer

Centro Universitário do Distrito Federal (UDF)

Brasilia, Brazil

Feb-July 2013

- Public Policy Evaluation (Undergraduate course).

Lecturer

Getúlio Vargas Foundation (FGV)

Brasilia, Brazil

Feb-July 2013

- Planning and Budgeting for the MBA in Public Management.

National School of Public Administration (ENAP)

2008-2012

- Professional courses in topics such as Brazilian State and Politics, Globalization, Public Administration and Development, and Ethics and Politics.

University of Brasilia

2006 & 2008

- Introduction to Political Science.

Grants, Awards and Fellowships

- 2025-2026: von der Heyden Global Fellowship, competitive fellowship and Duke Fellowship (\$31,875)
- 2024-2026: Social impact assessment of FSC in Brazil, awarded by Center for International Forestry Research (\$56,000)
- 2024: CLACS Research Travel Grant (\$3,000)
- 2021-2023: Latin American and Caribbean Studies Fellowship Award, Duke University (\$10,000)
- 2021-2022: Race and the Professions Fellowship - The Kenan Institute for Ethics at Duke University (\$3,000)
- 2017-2018: Dean’s Fellow for academic excellence, student leadership and community involvement
- 2016-2018: Global School of Policy and Strategy, University of California, San Diego - Fellowship Award (\$28,500)
- 2005-2006: Coordination for the Improvement of Higher Education (CAPES) - Graduate Fellowship
- 2004-2005: Vocation for Diplomacy Award – Rio Branco Institute (Brazilian Diplomacy Academy), (R\$25,000)
- 2002-2004: Special Training Program (fellowship granted by the Ministry of Education to high-performing Undergraduate Students)

Professional & Policy Experience

Before transitioning to Academia, I served as a [Specialist in Public Policy and Management](#) [📄](#) within the Brazilian Federal Civil Service. In this capacity, I have held the following leadership and technical roles:

Senior Policy Advisor <i>Ministry of Social Development</i>	<i>Brasilia, Brazil</i> <i>Jan 2019-Aug 2021</i>
◦ Deputy Chief of Staff of the Secretariat of Evaluation and Information Management (SAGI).	
Joint-Secretary for Racial Equality <i>Ministry of Human Rights</i>	<i>Brasilia, Brazil</i> <i>Jun 2018-Jan 2019</i>
Chief of Staff <i>National Council for Food Security</i>	<i>Brasilia, Brazil</i> <i>Aug 2014-Aug 2016</i>
Policy Analysis Manager <i>Office of the Presidency of the Republic of Brazil</i>	<i>Brasilia, Brazil</i> <i>Dec 2012-Aug 2014</i>
Advisor <i>National Council for Food Security and Ministry of Social Development</i>	<i>Brasilia, Brazil</i> <i>Feb 2009-Dec 2012</i>
Project Planning Manager <i>Ministry of Labor and Employment</i>	<i>Brasilia, Brazil</i> <i>Feb 2008-Feb 2009</i>
Advisor <i>Ministry of Labor and Employment</i>	<i>Brasilia, Brazil</i> <i>Jun 2006-Feb 2008</i>

Consulting Projects

- **CIFOR-ICRAF, 2025–2026:** Evaluation of environmental certification schemes, with a focus on development outcomes beyond environmental indicators.
- **Inter-American Development Bank (IDB), 2025–2026:** Impact evaluation of water quality on educational outcomes in Brazil.
- **USAID RTAC, 2022:** Assessment of climate “game changers” and requirements for adaptation interventions, emphasizing theory of change, vulnerability metrics, and foresight analysis.
- **Oxfam International, 2022:** Prepared background inputs for the report *Doing Business on Uneven Ground* [↗](#), examining land inequality in agri-food supply chains.

Other Projects / Service / Outreach

- Reviewer: *Environment and Development Economics*
- Reviewer: *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management*.
- Reviewer: World Congress of Environmental and Resource Economists (WCERE 2026)
- Reviewer: the journal *Questions in Politics*
- Reviewer: *Nexus: The Global South Journal* (Undergraduate Journal)
- Volunteer Work (during undergrad): Co-founder of the projects [Politeia](#) [↗](#) and [Politics at the School](#) [↗](#). Projects designed to promote civic values and educate young students about political participation and democratic institutions.

Skills & Additional Training

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (advanced), Spanish (Intermediate), French (beginner)

Statistical packages and Data Science Tools: STATA, R, Python, Git

Geospatial and Remote Sensing: ArcGIS, Quantum GIS, Google Earth Engine

Other tools: MS Office, Qualtrics, L^AT_EX

Additional training: Summer Institute in Computational Social Science - SICSS (2022); The Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research - IQMR, Syracuse University (2023)